Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

SAT OCT 17, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · SAT OCT 17 · NORTH PB

A little more swell, light offshore. Little Point all morning, then save some legs for Sunday.

the SSW bumped back up: paddle out by 7:00

PADDLE OUT BY	7:00	BOARD Inferno 72 ~71°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	7–11a · Inferno 72 · ~71°F
SURF	3–5 ft, sets 6 (SRF)
TIDE	L 0.9 @ 8:59p Fri H 4.4 @ 1:15p L 0.9 @ 10:24p obs 4.6 @ 6:42a

Read the gauge, not just the table.

7 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Good — worth rearranging your morning

capped by swell 3.3 ft · Better than 32% of 34 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3-5 FT, SETS 6 (SRF)

GROUND

SwH 3.3 ft · 14s

WINDSWELL

WWH 1.6 ft · 10s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.6 ft · 46258



FROM

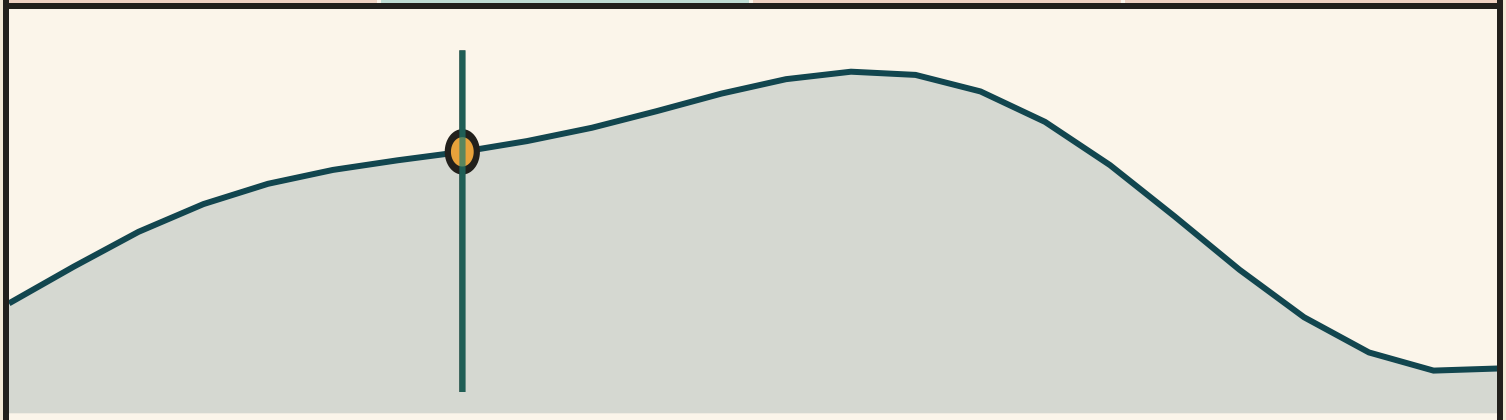
192° SSW

Buoy 46258 spectrum · ground 3.3 ft @ 14s SSW (13–20s overnight) + WWH 1.6 ft @ 10s · face 3–5 ft sets 6 (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 16s + NW 2 ft @ 12s · MWD 192° SSW · wind light NE/E early, calm late morning

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-7A · FIRST LIGHT	7–11A · LITTLE POINT	11A–2P · TIDE AT CEILING	3–5P DRAIN · LIGHT W
WAIT	GO	SKIP	MEH



7:00a	GO · Little Point	3.4 ft tide	E ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft, sets 6 (SRF)

L 0.9 @ 8:59p Fri · H 4.4 @ 1:15p · L 0.9 @ 10:24p · obs 4.6 @ 6:42a

Little Point, 7 to about 11a, on the Inferno 72. No morning low. The tide has been rising since last night's 0.9 ft low toward H 4.4 @ 1:15p. The gauge read 4.57 ft at 6:42a against 3.41 predicted, so it is running about 1.2 ft over the table. Add that to the table and the reef is near 5.3 ft by 11a and right at the 5.5 ft ceiling near 1p. Pier anemometer overnight: NNE to E 4–5 kt, NE 4 kt at 6a (LJAC1 NE 4 kt @ 6:00a). NWS hourly holds E 5 mph through 9a, calm 10a to noon, then SW and W 5 mph from 1p. The marine zone is breezier (PZZ740 E 10–15 kt, gusts 20), so expect some texture in the gusts early. Afternoon drain under light W wind is a soft maybe only. Sunrise 6:54a, sunset 6:15p.

Where it's working

★ Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 0.98. The SSW groundswell ticked back up overnight (46258 SwH 3.3 ft @ 14s, MWD 191–202°), and the tide is rising slowly toward a low 4.4 ft high at 1:15p. The gauge read 4.57 ft at 6:42a against 3.41 predicted, about 1.2 ft over the table, so the reef sits near the top of its 3.0–5.5 ft band by late morning and touches the ceiling around 1p. Pier wind NE 4 kt now, NWS E 5 mph through 9a then calm until noon. Paddle out by 7:00.

CALL

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2 **PB Drive**

Score 0.97. Also fine on the same light offshore if Little Point is packed. Softer sandbar peaks on 3.3 ft groundswell; bring the Anvil if you land here.

ALSO

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3 **Calumet**

Score 0.83. Good swell angle, but flagged tide-high vs its lower window on this flood. Pass.

SOFT

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4 **Tourmaline**

Score 0.75. Rideable, but too full as the tide climbs past 5 ft on the gauge.

SOFT

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5 **PB north of the pier**

Score 0.72. SSW mostly misses the pier wedge; the NW 2 ft @ 12s in PZZ740 is too small to fix it.

SOFT

• Skip · PB Point (0.56) is too full on the high gauge. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) and OB want W groundswell and a lower tide; today is SSW on a flooding mid–high. Scripps and Blacks are extended only and do not beat a local reef on light offshore SSW.

SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~71°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Clean 14-second groundswell on a steep reef with light offshore, a touch bigger than yesterday. Punchy Inferno territory at Little Point, not mushy sandbar.

Anvil twin · if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Read the gauge, not just the table.

The tide table says 3.4 ft at 6:42a, but the La Jolla gauge read 4.6. Warm water and the swell itself can hold the sea a foot above the prediction for days. Add today's gap to the table and Little Point fills to its ceiling around 1p instead of never. Check the live gauge before you trust the printed tide.

SKIP

Little Point after about 11a, when the gauge-adjusted tide nears the 5.5 ft ceiling. Everything from late morning through the 1:15p high. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on this flood. The Cliffs and OB on a SSW primary swell.

GOTCHAS

Little Point is a shallow reef with a tight takeoff, so it crowds fast on a Saturday, and the rocks show as it drains. High rip current risk today (NWS SRF). Fourteen-second sets mean lulls, then a solid set. Hot again: the pier read 81°F air at 6a and NWS has the coast near 85°F with a slight chance of a stray shower, so bring water for the stairs at Fern Glen. PZZ740 has E 10–15 kt gusting 20 offshore; the beach should be lighter, but do not wait for midday.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES